

MADHYASTH DARSHAN · CO-EXISTENTIALISM

The Epistemology of Coexistence

Knowledge, knower, and known — understanding completed in humane conduct

Based on Knowledge, Knower, and Known (AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org)

Primary texts of Shri A. Nagraj — MVD · KD · SB · JV (tr. Rakesh Gupta) · 1 / 25





The Argument in Three Movements

- 1 What knowledge is, and what it must include — realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct; not information or conviction alone.
- 2 How jeevan knows — ten coordinated activities, working inward as reflection and outward as projection through the human joint form.
- 3 How understanding becomes evidence — action, result, evaluation, behaviour, experiment, conveyance, and participation in orderliness.

One claim carries all three: knowledge becomes complete only when knower, known, and lived evidence become mutually coherent. · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 2 / 25



The Questions Epistemology Must Answer

- ❓ What is knowledge? — Is it information, belief, experience, realised understanding, or all of these in a definite relation?
- ❓ Who is the knower? — What persists as the bearer of attention, thought, resolve, realisation, and evaluation?
- ❓ What is known? — Is the object only an external thing, or the whole field of coexistence, self, relationship, and conduct?
- ❓ How does knowing occur? — Through which activities, means, disciplines, and embodied conditions does understanding mature?
- ❓ How is error possible? — Where do delusion, false learning, contradiction, and mis-evaluation enter the process?
- ❓ What counts as evidence? — How must realisation face action, result, public conduct, experiment, and transmission?

*Madhyasth Darshan answers all six by joining ontology, active selfhood, conduct, and consequence. ·
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Knowledge Is Realised Understanding

Pervasive gyan

Coexistence is orderly and available for understanding because every unit is saturated in Omnipresence. Calling Omnipresence Knowledge names this all-pervasive ground; it does not make the ground a perceiving subject.

Knowledge Unfolding

Active knowing occurs in jeevan. Gyan-udghatan is the unfolding of what is understood through an awakened human being — in thought, evaluation, behaviour, work, and communication.

Completion

Human knowledge is realised understanding expressed as knowledge, wisdom, and science. It is complete when reality, self, relationship, and conduct are understood together.

COEXISTENCE — reality available for understanding



*knowledge is pervasive; knowing is an activity of jeevan;
evidence appears through the human joint form*



What Knowledge Must Include

Complete knowledge is threefold. Each content corrects a partial epistemology: reality without the knower is incomplete; self-knowledge without conduct is unproven; conduct without the whole lacks orientation.



Existence as coexistence

Omnipresence and all real units; their form, properties, essential nature, dharma, relationships, and participation in orderliness.



Jeevan

The sentient unit that bears attention, reflection, resolve, enlightenment, realisation, selection, evaluation, and authenticity.



Humane conduct

The right recognition and fulfilment of relationships, made evident as justice, work, behaviour, and participation in universal orderliness.



§1.2

Knowledge, Knower, and Known



Knowledge

Realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct — accepted, evaluated, and capable of guiding action.



Knower

Jeevan is the sentient bearer of knowing; the human being is the embodied participant through whom knowing is spoken, tested, and lived.



Known

Existence as coexistence: units, relationships, values, orderliness, and the conditions in which human aspiration can be fulfilled.



Meaningful evidence

The known becomes meaningful when understanding appears as resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, coexistence, and an awakened tradition.

The roles remain distinct: jeevan knows, coexistence is known, and knowledge is their realised relation made evident in life.



Three Domains of Knowledge

The known is not exhausted by measurable form and property. Madhyasth Darshan distinguishes three connected domains, each with its own objects, capacities, and forms of evidence.



Physical knowledge

Form, property, material composition, production, and skill — knowledge expressed as effective engagement with material nature.



Intellectual knowledge

Meaning, relation, purpose, analysis, evaluation, and proficiency — thought disciplined by what is and what fulfils orderliness.



Coexistential knowledge

Realisation of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct — the horizon within which physical and intellectual knowledge find direction.



Knowing Appears in Relational Triads



Seeing — seen — view

Seeing is never bare intake: what is seen and the view through which it is understood arise in a definite relation.



Attention — attender

Attention belongs to an active jeevan. The attender selects, compares, reflects, and becomes answerable for what is accepted.



Aim — seeker — means

Seeking joins aspiration to a seeker and to the means chosen. An aim cannot be assessed apart from capacity and method.



Cause — doer — effect

Action joins need, agent, deed, result, and wider effect. Consequence therefore returns as material for evaluation.

The knower does not stand outside experience: perspective, attention, purpose, action, and result remain relational throughout.



Reflection Coordinates Five Activity Pairs

The ten activities are five coordinated pairs in jeevan. In reflection, sensation, behaviour, thought, desire, and resolve are examined until enlightenment and realisation become effective.

Jeevan — five loci

- Atma — realisation and authenticity
- Buddhi — enlightenment and resolve
- Chitta — contemplation and visualisation
- Vritti — deliberation and analysis
- Mun — taste and selection



Reflection — knowing moves inward

- Mun and vritti attend to experience. Chitta forms meaning, buddhi resolves, and atma realises. Higher activities orient and integrate those below without becoming separate minds.

“Inward” is a teaching description of coordinated activity; the canonical taxonomy is the five loci and their ten activities.



Projection Carries Understanding Outward

Projection is the evidencing direction of the same ten activities. Realisation and resolve become visualisation, analysis, selection, bodily action, work, behaviour, and communication.

Jeevan — projected strengths

- Atma — authenticity
- Buddhi — resolve
- Chitta — visualisation
- Vritti — analysis
- Mun — selection



Human joint form — lived expression

- Jeevan supplies meaning and direction. Brain, senses, speech, movement, and social participation place the projection in a shared world where result can be evaluated.

Reflection and projection are recurrent directions of one active jeevan; neither is complete when isolated from the other.



Knowing and Doing Form a Recurrent Cycle

This four-step diagram is a pedagogical synthesis of the textual account: attention and reflection deepen knowing; realisation and projection place it back into action and result.

Inward movement

Experience and consequence return to jeevan through attention and reflection until meaning becomes clear and resolvable.

Outward evidence

Realisation projects as selection, action, behaviour, work, communication, and evaluation in the human joint form.

Each coherent cycle can deepen the next; reflection without projection remains unevidenced, while projection without reflection repeats habit.



Result and evaluation return the projected action to renewed attention.



Jeevan Knows; the Body Mediates

Knowing belongs to jeevan, but human evidence requires the joint form. The body supplies sensory access, brain-mediated signalling, speech, movement, work, and participation with others.

Jeevan — sentient bearer

- Realisation, enlightenment, contemplation, deliberation, selection
- Evaluation of relationship and value
- Continuity of the knower across bodily change



Human joint form — lived evidence

- Brain and senses carry signals and bodily conditions
- Speech and action place understanding in a shared world
- Work, behaviour, and teaching make claims answerable to result

The texts specify a functional relation between jeevan and the brain; a more precise account of their interaction remains an open task within the exposition.



Delusion or Awakening

The decisive question is not whether jeevan is active, but what its activity takes as the self and what reference points organise attention, desire, thought, resolve, and action.

Delusion

Jeevan identifies with the body. Only four-and-a-half activities become effective: taste, selection, analysis, visualisation, and restricted deliberation governed by sensation, health, and profit.

Awakening

Jeevan knows itself and coexistence. The same faculties align around justice, dharma, truth, resolution, and fulfilment of relationship.

The faculties do not disappear in awakening; their direction and coordination change. Error is incomplete functioning of the knower, not mere absence of data.



The aspiration for happiness remains, while conduct organised by sensation repeatedly fails to secure it.



Knowing Must Continue Through Evaluation

Knowing alone is not yet stable knowledge. What is understood must be accepted, used to recognise actual relationships, fulfilled with capacity, and evaluated by its result.

Understanding

Knowing and believing belong together: accept what is known, and examine what is accepted until it is known.

Justice

Recognition, fulfilment, evaluation, and mutual satisfaction complete the epistemic sequence in relationship.

A correct idea becomes living knowledge only when it reorganises attention, choice, relationship, work, and evaluation.



Evaluating closes the loop: did the relationship and value become fulfilled, and what must be corrected?



Every Karma Has a Structure

Activity together with aspiration is karma. Every intentional action contains a doer, cause, objective, result, and effect. Knowledge therefore becomes answerable to consequence: an intention is not sufficient, and a result cannot be judged without its aim, means, and reach.



*What is sought?
What would count as fulfillment?*



*What is chosen and done?
With what capacity and means?*



*What actually follows?
Does it satisfy the accepted aim?*

Five limbs of karma

Doer — who acts

Cause — the need

Objective — the aim

Result — the fruit

Effect — its wider reach



Consequence Returns as Evidence

Result is not the end of the process. It returns through evaluation: did the relationship, purpose, and value become fulfilled? The answer may confirm understanding or expose where conception, recognition, capacity, or action was incomplete.



*the fruit and effect
of action in context*



*compare result with
relationship and aim*



*corrected acceptance
shapes later projection*

Three evaluation errors

Over-evaluation
Under-evaluation
Mis-evaluation

Each can preserve
contradiction while appearing
certain.



Seer, Doer, and Enjoyer

The awakened human is seer, doer, and enjoyer in one joint form. Seer-status establishes understanding; doing places it in action; enjoyer-status names the experienced fruit or fruition of action.



*goal: realised seeing
coexistence and relationship
known*



*goal: authentic conduct
work and behaviour aligned*



*receives fruition; in awakened
conduct this supports mutual
satisfaction*

One human joint form

*The seer does not withdraw
from action.*

The doer is guided by
understanding.

The enjoyer receives the result
and evaluates its fit with the
accepted aim.

Mutual satisfaction is the awakened humane instance of fruition; it is not the definition of enjoyer-status in every action.



Realisation Must Become Publicly Legible

Madhyasth Darshan begins with realisation, but it does not end in private certitude. A claim must travel through behaviour, experiment, evaluation, and conveyance until its coherence can be encountered by others.

Realisation — first-person

The knower directly understands coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct; authenticity is the capacity to bear and evidence that understanding.

Behaviour — relational

Recognition and fulfilment of values make understanding visible in family and social relationships, where mutual satisfaction can be assessed.

Experiment — practical

Work and productive participation expose understanding to material conditions, consequences, repeatability, and correction.

Transmission — second-person

The learner must be able to understand, live, evaluate, and convey the proposal without depending on borrowed authority or verbal repetition.



Three Routes, One Integrating Criterion



Direct perception

Brings form, property, event, and relation into experiential proximity through disciplined attention and embodied access.



Inference

Extends understanding beyond what is presently near, while remaining answerable to possibility, coherence, and subsequent evaluation.



Testimony-activity

Receives what has been understood and conveyed by an awakened human, then places it under study, reflection, practice, and verification.



Realisation — integrating criterion

Realisation is not a fourth input alongside perception, inference, and testimony. It integrates what is understood and must become capable of coherent projection and evidence.

Perception, inference, and testimony-activity are cognitive routes. Reflection and action mature them toward realisation, whose adequacy is tested in evidence.



Study Must Mature Beyond Belief

Study begins with the possibility of realisation and includes language, definition, comparison within experience, reflection, practice, work, behaviour, and evaluation. Guidance matters, but deference cannot establish truth.

Study

A proposal is clarified in language, examined in reflection, tested in relationship and work, and revised where result exposes contradiction.

Guidance and tradition

An awakened human helps the learner direct attention and distinguish understanding from repetition; the learner must become independently capable of evidence.

Study is in, by, and for realisation in coexistence. Transmission succeeds when the understanding can be lived, evaluated, and conveyed again without loss or compulsion.



The proof of comprehension includes the ability to make the understanding accessible to another person.



Three Failures Block Knowing

Error is diagnosed by where the knowing process loses contact with reality, self, relationship, or result. Information and confidence can remain high while the deeper sequence is broken.

Delusion — bham

Jeevan is identified with the body; sensitivity becomes the governing reference, and believing separates from knowing.

Intellectual mystery — rahasyata

Reflection does not reach realisation, or realisation does not project as evidence; the faculties remain misaligned.

False learning is the middle failure: form, property, essential nature, or dharma is not understood as it is, producing doubt, over-evaluation, under-evaluation, and mis-evaluation.

Doubt



Mis-evaluation



Contradiction



Correction

Correction requires renewed attention, reflection, action, result, and evaluation — not a stronger assertion of the original belief.



Coherence Without Merger

At realisation, the triad is completed without erasing its terms. Coexistence remains real, jeevan remains a distinct active knower, and knowledge is the realised relation that becomes wisdom, science, and humane conduct.

Knowledge — realised relation

Understanding joins what exists, who understands it, and how that understanding must guide evaluation and participation.

Knower — distinct jeevan

Jeevan bears realisation and authenticity; the human joint form makes these capacities communicable and answerable to consequence.

Known — real coexistence

Omnipresence, units, orders, relationships, values, and humane conduct remain the real field of knowing; they are not dissolved by understanding.

Meaning — awakened living

The known becomes meaningful as resolution in the person, prosperity in the family, fearlessness in society, and coexistence in universal orderliness.



Safeguards Against Self-Confirmation

- 1 Separate structure from contingency — realisation of coexistence does not imply knowledge of every changing fact; empirical claims remain open to correction.
- 2 Demand coherence across domains — sound conduct cannot silently prove every ontological claim, and private certitude cannot replace failed relationship or result.
- 3 Keep metaphysical claims and transmission corrigible — teacher and tradition require room for disagreement; jeevan–body interaction and post-death persistence remain primary MD commitments until independently evidenced.

The method is strongest when mixed results and evidential limits are named plainly, and no single success substitutes for the whole chain. · AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org · 23 / 25



The Questions, Answered

-  What is knowledge? — Realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct, accepted and evidenced in life.
-  Who is the knower? — Jeevan, active through the human joint form as seer, doer, enjoyer, evaluator, and communicator.
-  What is known? — Coexistence: units, orders, relationships, values, self, and humane participation.
-  How does knowing occur? — Through ten activities coordinated as reflection and projection across study and action.
-  How is error corrected? — Through renewed attention, action, result, evaluation, and correction.
-  What counts as evidence? — Coherence of realisation, behaviour, experiment, conveyance, mutual satisfaction, and tradition.

*Knowledge is complete when knower, known, and evidence no longer contradict one another. ·
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THE CULMINATION · KNOWLEDGE EVIDENCED ACROSS LIFE

An Awakened Human Tradition

Knowledge is complete when realisation coheres across thought, relationship, work, evaluation, and transmission.

Resolution

in every person

Prosperity

in every family

Fearlessness

trust in society

Coexistence

with all of nature

An awakened tradition makes understanding renewable. ·

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